

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA STATUTORY REGULATORY REPOSITORY

AYURLEX COMPLIANCE HANDBOOK — GEOGRAPHICAL INDICATIONS OF GOODS ACT, 1999

6. Geographical Indications of Goods Act, 1999

Domain Identifier: gi | Statutory Authority: Geographical Indications Registry (CGPDTM, Chennai)

Legislative Base: The Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999 (Act No. 48 of 1999).

Statutory Provisions & Collective Heritage Protection:

- **Section 2(1)(e) — Definition of GI:** An indication identifying goods as originating in a territory or region where quality, reputation, or characteristics are essentially attributable to geographical origin.
- **Section 8 & 11 — Collective Community Registration:** GI tags can only be applied for and held by an association representing regional growers/artisans. *Sole private corporate entities cannot own a GI tag.*
- **Section 21 & 22 — Protection Against Infringement & Dilution:** Exclusive right of authorized users and statutory power to sue for unfair competition and consumer deception under Section 22.
- **Indexed Ayurvedic & Botanical GI Tag Examples:**
 - **Kashmir Saffron (GI No. 635):** Sourced from high altitude karewa lands; celebrated in classical Ayurveda as Kumkuma (Crocus sativus).
 - **Navara Rice (GI No. 47):** Indigenous medicinal rice from Kerala used in classical Shashtika Shali Pinda Sweda therapy.
 - **Malabar Pepper (GI No. 49) & Alleppey Green Cardamom (GI No. 65):** Canonical ingredients of Trikatu and classical digestive formulations.

Optimal RAG Queries for this Dataset:

1. 'What is a GI tag and how does it protect regional Ayurvedic crops?' → Returns Section 2(1)(e) and collective monopoly rules.
2. 'Can my private company register Kashmir Saffron as our exclusive trademark?' → Returns Sections 8/11 GI collective rights and Section 9 trademark bar.